

1.8.2 Troubleshooting Shutdown Problems

► **Problem:** When you click on “Shut down”, XP reboots!

Cause: Windows XP, by default, is configured to restart in case of an error. This behavior may occur if an error is generated during the shutdown process. It could be either hardware or a software problem.

Solution: Disable Automatic

Restart. Right-click My

Computer. Select Properties >

Advanced > Settings > Startup

and Recovery. Clear the

“Automatically Restart” check-

box. Shut down the computer

and see if you get an error mes-

sage or a BSOD. Follow the trou-

bleshooting steps explained ear-

lier in the *BSOD* section of this

guide. If there is no error mes-

sage or BSOD, check your hard-

ware. Some of the most com-

mon culprits are CD-Writing

software suites (Roxio, Nero, etc.), some specialty keyboards such

as Internet keyboards, USB devices, and power management set-

tings. Check the drivers for all the hardware devices and update

them if possible. Unplug the hardware devices one by one and go

through the shutdown process to isolate the device. Check the

power management settings and switch to the “Always On” option.

Troubleshoot problems with Windows system services as

explained earlier in this chapter.

Tip

Disabling the wrong service will cause further problems so be sure of the service you wish to disable. If you wish to re-enable a service from Recovery Console type “enable <service-name_type>”. Here, service-name_type should be the same type that was showed on your screen when you shut down the service.

► **Problem:** The system hangs at the “Saving your settings” screen.

Cause: This is a known issue in older XP releases, and can be patched by upgrading to Service Pack 1. Also, some software drivers “lock” during the shutdown process, preventing Windows XP from shutting down completely.

Solution: Upgrade your system to at least Service Pack 1. Update the